

INSIDE Photoshop CS3

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By the time you read this, you will have witnessed the biggest software launch in Adobe's history—twelve products, spanning the entire range of Adobe's flagship products and those of the erstwhile Macromedia. Some months ago, Adobe released the Photoshop CS3 public beta; we've also been treated to a preview of the entire CS3 suite by Adobe's Director of Product Management (Creative Solutions) Will Eisley, and we're at the edge of our seats with anticipation. Here, we take an in-depth look at Photoshop CS3's new features; get the beta off our February 2007 DVD to check these out. We've used a February 2007 beta of Photoshop CS3 Extended, which we got off Adobe for this review. You'll find the following a lot easier to understand if you've used Photoshop for a while, or if you've read our *Fast Track to Photoshop* in May 2006.

Brace yourself—Photoshop CS3 (not to forget the rest of the suite) will blow you away

The Obvious

The first thing we noticed about the new Photoshop was the absence of ImageReady. While it was a useful tool, it just didn't make sense, because it shared most of Photoshop's features anyway. You'll find ImageReady's functions embedded within Photoshop itself. The next thing—and we were surprised at this—is that it starts up and runs considerably faster than CS2. In fact, even over time, CS3 runs smoothly where CS2 used to get sluggish. On Windows Vista and Mac OS X, you can even enable GPU support for rendering graphics.

The interface has been spruced up to match the new interfaces of Premiere and After Effects—with docked palettes that can easily be expanded or collapsed as your needs dictate. The layout is the same, though, so you don't have to re-learn anything; the interface affects usability a bit more subtly than you'd think. For one, the quick expanding and collapsing enables you to increase screen real-estate much quicker; no more going to the Window menu to show palettes you closed. The [Tab] key now auto-hides the palettes—moving the mouse cursor to the

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